HARMONY · INVERSIONS · LEARN

# Inversions

**REMEMBER** Root at the bottom: root position. 3rd at the bottom: 1st inversion. 5th at the bottom: 2nd inversion.

## 1 Which position?

★☆☆

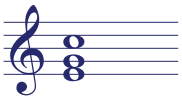
Circle the position of each C, F or G major chord (read from the bottom note up). The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **C E G** | **root** · 1st · 2nd |
| **E G C** | root · 1st · 2nd |
| **G C E** | root · 1st · 2nd |
| **A C F** | root · 1st · 2nd |
| **C F A** | root · 1st · 2nd |
| **B D G** | root · 1st · 2nd |
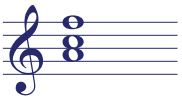
## 2 Find the root

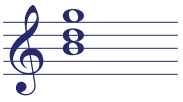
★★☆

Restack each chord in 3rds and write its root. The first is done.

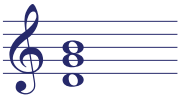


**C**











## 3 Write the inversions

★★☆

Write each chord in its 1st and 2nd inversion. The first row is done.

| CHORD | ROOT POSITION | 1ST INVERSION | 2ND INVERSION |
|---|---|---|---|
| **C** | C E G | **E G C** | **G C E** |
| **F** | F A C | | |
| **G** | G B D | | |
| **Am** | A C E | | |

Date _____

HARMONY · INVERSIONS · USE

# Inversions

**REMEMBER** Keep any shared note; move the others to the nearest note of the next chord.

## 1 Draw the 2nd inversion ★★☆

Next to each chord, draw its 2nd inversion: lift the two bottom notes to the top. Example: C E G becomes G C E.



## 2 Slash chords ★★☆

Write the notes from the bottom up. The first is done.

| SYMBOL | NOTES, BOTTOM UP |
|---|---|
| C/E | E G C |
| G/B | |
| F/A | |
| Am/C | |

## 3 The common note ★★☆

Write the note (or notes) the two chords share. The first is done.

| CHORDS | SHARED | CHORDS | SHARED |
|---|---|---|---|
| C and F | C | Am and F | |
| C and G | | Em and C | |

## 4 Name it ★★☆

Write the chord symbol with its bass note, like C/E. The first is done.



C/E _____ _____ _____ _____

## 5 Play it smoothly ★☆☆

Play C E G, C F A, B D G, C E G, left hand; then in G: G B D, G C E, F♯ A D, G B D.

**in C** ○ ○ ○ ○ **in G** ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____